Saudi Airports Status

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Saudi Arabia launches new Jeddah Airport and aims for 150 million passengers

Kingdom's aviation ambition takes flight as King Abdulaziz International Airport opens its doors to the world

Jeddah, Saudi Arabia — March 14, 2026 — In the heart of the Red Sea coast, a new gateway to the world has opened its doors. King Abdulaziz International Airport, Jeddah's long-awaited replacement for its historic but overwhelmed predecessor, welcomed its first commercial flight on Thursday morning. The ceremony, attended by senior government officials, airline executives and hundreds of invited guests, marked the culmination of a construction project that began in 2019 and has cost an estimated $7.2 billion.

The new airport is the centrepiece of a broader ambition. Saudi Arabia wants to transform Jeddah from a transit point for pilgrims travelling to Mecca into a destination in its own right, and to position the city as the kingdom's principal commercial hub. The airport has been designed with that goal in mind: it can handle 80 million passengers a year at first, with the capacity to grow to 150 million, and it includes a dedicated terminal for Hajj and Umrah pilgrims that is separated from the rest of the operation.

Read more

Airline schedules & staffing reporting

Airline Schedule Reporting Standard (ASRS) — Standardized XML schema for publishing flight schedules, codeshares, and aircraft rotations

Airline Staffing Ratio — Number of employees per aircraft operated, used to benchmark labor efficiency across carriers

Airport Slot Coordination — Process by which airlines request and receive takeoff and landing times at congested airports

Block Hour — Time from when an aircraft first moves for departure until it stops at the destination gate

Crew Duty Period — Maximum continuous time a flight crew may work before mandatory rest

Crew Pairing — Sequence of flights assigned to a crew that begins and ends at their home base

Crew Rest Facility — Onboard area where flight crew can take mandatory breaks during long-haul flights

Deadhead — Crew member flying as a passenger to reposition for a duty assignment

Delay Code — Standardized numeric code assigned to the cause of a flight delay for reporting purposes

Dispatch Release — Document authorizing a flight to depart, signed by the pilot and dispatcher

Duty Time — Total time a crew member is on duty, including pre-flight and post-flight tasks

Equipment Swap — Replacing the aircraft assigned to a flight, usually due to maintenance or capacity

Fatigue Risk Management System (FRMS) — Data-driven approach to managing crew fatigue beyond prescriptive rules

Flight Attendant Ratio — Number of cabin crew required per seat or per passenger on a given aircraft

Flight Number — Unique identifier assigned to a scheduled flight, typically two letters and up to four digits

Flight Time Limitation (FTL) — Regulatory limit on how many hours a crew member may fly in a given period

Ground Handling — Services provided to aircraft on the ground, including baggage, fueling, and boarding

Ground Time — Scheduled time an aircraft spends at the gate between arrival and departure

Hub Connection — Flight scheduled to allow passengers to transfer between two flights at a hub airport

Irregular Operations (IROPS) — Disruptions to the normal flight schedule caused by weather, crew, or technical issues

Layover — Scheduled rest period between two flights for a crew member

Load Factor — Percentage of available seats filled with paying passengers on a flight

Maintenance Check — Scheduled inspection of an aircraft, ranging from A-check to heavy D-check

Maintenance Deferral — Authorization to operate an aircraft with a known defect for a limited time

Maintenance Routing — Assignment of aircraft to flights so they return to a maintenance base on schedule

Minimum Connect Time (MCT) — Shortest allowed time between arriving and departing flights for a connection

Minimum Equipment List (MEL) — List of components that may be inoperative while still allowing dispatch

Night Duty — Work performed between local midnight and 6 a.m., often subject to special rules

Operational Control (OCC) — Center responsible for monitoring and managing the airline's flight operations

Overnight Rest — Mandatory rest period between duty days for crew members

Pairing Optimization — Algorithmic process of building efficient crew pairings from a flight schedule

Passenger Name Record (PNR) — Reservation data stored for each passenger booking

Pilot Ratio — Number of pilots required per aircraft, typically two for commercial flights

Positioning Flight — Flight operated solely to move an aircraft or crew to a different location

Reserve Crew — Crew members on standby to cover unexpected absences or disruptions

Revenue Passenger Kilometer (RPK) — One paying passenger flown one kilometer, used to measure traffic

Schedule Buffer — Extra time added to a flight to absorb minor delays and improve on-time performance

Schedule Recovery — Process of restoring the planned schedule after a major disruption

Seat Capacity — Total number of passenger seats available on a flight

Slot Pair — Matched arrival and departure slots assigned to a single flight

Station Manager — Airport-level supervisor responsible for ground operations at a specific location

Tail Number — Unique registration identifier painted on the aircraft's fuselage

Turnaround Time — Minimum time required between an aircraft's arrival and its next departure

Wet Lease — Aircraft rented with crew, maintenance, and insurance included

Wide-body Aircraft — Large aircraft with two aisles, typically used for long-haul routes

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